

BUILDDECK_WORKSPACE_DESIGN_SYSTEM.md

Builddeck Workspace

Product Vision

Builddeck Workspace is a founder-focused Product Operating System designed to help entrepreneurs manage products from idea to launch.

The platform combines:

- Product Management
- Roadmap Planning
- Task Execution
- Launch Planning
- Calendar Scheduling
- Documentation

into a single founder workspace.

Builddeck Workspace is not intended to be:

- A CRM
- A Team Chat Application
- An Enterprise Project Management Suite
- An AI Assistant Platform
- A Generic Notion Clone

Instead, it should feel purpose-built for founders and product builders.

Core Philosophy

A founder should be able to manage:

- Product Vision
- Product Roadmap
- Product Tasks
- Product Documentation
- Product Launches

without requiring multiple tools.

Target Users

Primary Users:

- Indie Hackers
- Startup Founders
- Solopreneurs
- Product Builders
- Small Startup Teams

Secondary Users:

- Product Managers
 - Startup Operators
 - Agencies Managing Multiple Products
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Product Positioning

Builddeck Workspace is:

"Your Product Operating System"

Helping founders move through:

Idea ↓ Validation ↓ Planning ↓ Building ↓ Launching ↓ Growing

Design Inspiration

Take inspiration from:

- Linear
- Vercel Dashboard
- Stripe Dashboard
- Notion
- AppFlowy (workflow inspiration only)

Do NOT copy:

- AppFlowy UI
- Notion UI
- Linear UI

Create a unique Builddeck identity.

Design Principles

Simplicity

Every screen should feel:

- Fast
- Focused
- Minimal

Avoid clutter.

Founder First

The UI should answer:

- What am I building?
 - What should I do next?
 - When am I launching?
 - What is blocked?
-

Product-Centric

Products are the top-level entity.

Structure:

Workspace → Products → Tasks → Roadmaps → Calendar → Documents

NOT:

Workspace → Projects → Tasks

Action-Oriented

Every screen should encourage:

- Building

- Shipping
- Launching

Avoid excessive configuration.

Branding

Product Name:

Builddeck Workspace

Brand Family:

Builddeck

Brand Personality:

- Professional
 - Trustworthy
 - Product Focused
 - Founder Focused
 - Execution Oriented
-

Color Palette

Background:

0F172A

Surface:

111827

Primary:

3B82F6

Accent:

60A5FA

Success:

10B981

Warning:

F59E0B

Error:

EF4444

Text Primary:

F9FAFB

Text Secondary:

94A3B8

Border:

1E293B

Typography

Font Family:

Inter

Hierarchy:

Page Titles: 32px

Section Titles: 24px

Card Titles: 18px

Body Text: 14px

Labels: 12px

Font Weight:

Regular: 400

Medium: 500

Semi Bold: 600

Bold: 700

Layout Guidelines

Use generous spacing.

Avoid crowded layouts.

Cards should have:

- Clear hierarchy
- Visual breathing room
- Strong contrast

Prefer:

- Cards
- Lists
- Tables
- Timeline Views

Avoid:

- Overly dense grids
 - Complex nested navigation
-

Navigation Structure

Persistent Left Sidebar

Sections:

- Dashboard
- Products
- Tasks
- Roadmaps
- Calendar
- Documents
- Settings

Top Navigation:

- Workspace Switcher
 - Search
 - Notifications
 - User Profile
-

Product Statuses

Products:

- Idea
- Validation
- Building
- Launching
- Live
- Archived

Color Coding:

Idea: Gray

Validation: Purple

Building: Blue

Launching: Orange

Live: Green

Archived: Neutral

Task Priorities

- Low
- Medium
- High
- Critical

Colors:

Low: Blue

Medium: Orange

High: Red

Critical: Dark Red

Roadmap Statuses

- Planned
- In Progress
- Completed
- Blocked

Colors:

Planned: Gray

In Progress: Blue

Completed: Green

Blocked: Red

Calendar Event Types

- Launch
- Milestone
- Deadline

- Meeting

Each should have unique visual indicators.

Empty States

Every screen must include meaningful empty states.

Example:

"No products yet. Create your first product and start building."

Empty states should include:

- Illustration
 - Helpful message
 - Primary action
-

Loading States

Every major widget should have:

- Skeleton Cards
- Skeleton Tables
- Skeleton Lists

Avoid loading spinners whenever possible.

Responsive Design

Required:

- Desktop
- Tablet
- Mobile

Mobile should feel like a native SaaS application.

Accessibility

Support:

- Keyboard Navigation
 - High Contrast
 - Focus States
 - Screen Reader Friendly Components
-

V1 Scope

Included:

- Dashboard
- Products
- Tasks
- Kanban
- Roadmaps
- Calendar
- Documents
- Settings

Excluded:

- AI Features
 - CRM
 - Team Chat
 - Custom Database Builder
 - Whiteboard
 - Automations
 - Marketplace
 - Enterprise Features
 - SSO
 - Offline Mode
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Success Criteria

A founder should be able to manage:

- Product Strategy
- Product Execution
- Product Launches

- Product Documentation

without needing Notion, ClickUp, Jira, or AppFlowy.

The experience should feel like a premium Founder Operating System.